

SECTION 2 - COMPREHENSION

Q1. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions below.

In the late 21st century, the Global Council enacted the "Resource Equilibrium Accord" to address escalating conflicts over dwindling freshwater reserves. The Accord introduced a tiered quota system, assigning water access rights based on each nation's ecological footprint, technological capability for desalination, and per-capita consumption history.

While wealthier nations invested in advanced desalination plants and atmospheric water harvesters, poorer nations – despite having smaller ecological footprints – struggled to meet their citizens' basic needs under their reduced quotas.

Critics argued that the Accord unintentionally entrenched inequality, as historical consumption patterns favored nations that had previously overused water.

To address the backlash, an amendment proposed the creation of a "Water Equity Fund" financed by a surcharge on nations exceeding their quota. The fund would support sustainable water projects in under-resourced regions.

Yet, debates continued over enforcement: how to monitor usage accurately, prevent data manipulation, and ensure that the fund genuinely benefited those in need.

11. What was the main goal behind the introduction of the Resource Equilibrium Accord in the late 21st century?

- A. To establish a global water trading market
- B. To balance global water distribution and prevent conflicts over freshwater resources
- C. To reward nations with low per-capita water consumption
- D. To increase funding for desalination research

12. Which aspect most contributed to the Resource Equilibrium Accord unintentionally reinforcing inequality among nations?

- A. Technological advancements in desalination
- B. Inaccurate monitoring of water usage
- C. Historical consumption patterns that benefited countries with prior high water use
- D. Opposition to the Water Equity Fund

13. Which conclusion is best supported by the information provided in the passage about the Resource Equilibrium Accord?

- A. The amendment eliminated all concerns about fairness
- B. Nations with smaller ecological footprints were given larger quotas
- C. Wealthier nations opposed atmospheric water harvesting
- D. The Accord unintentionally reinforced pre-existing inequalities

14. Under the Resource Equilibrium Accord, when would a nation be required to pay a surcharge to support the Water Equity Fund?

- A. When its per-capita consumption is below the global average
- B. When it fails to reduce its ecological footprint

- C. When it does not participate in atmospheric water harvesting
- D. When its water usage exceeds the assigned quota

15. What is the main challenge that remains unresolved regarding the amendment to the Resource Equilibrium Accord?

- A. Lack of sustainable water project ideas
- B. The unwillingness of wealthier nations to pay surcharges
- C. Uncertainty in the fund's revenue source
- D. Ensuring transparency and preventing misuse of funds

Q2. Archaeology as a profession faces two major problems.

First, it is the poorest of the poor. Only paltry sums are available for excavating and even less is available for publishing the results and preserving the sites once excavated. Yet archaeologists deal with priceless objects every day.

Second, there is the problem of illegal excavation, resulting in museum-quality pieces being sold to the highest bidder.

I would like to make an outrageous suggestion that would at one stroke provide funds for archaeology and reduce the amount of illegal digging. I would propose that scientific archaeological expeditions and governmental authorities sell excavated artifacts on the open market. Such sales would provide substantial funds for the excavation and preservation of archaeological sites and the publication of results. At the same time, they would break the illegal excavator's grip on the market, thereby decreasing the inducement to engage in illegal activities.

You might object that professionals excavate to acquire knowledge, not money. Moreover, ancient artifacts are part of our global cultural heritage, which should be available for all to appreciate, not sold to the highest bidder. I agree. Sell nothing that has unique artistic merit or scientific value. But, you might reply, everything that comes out of the ground has scientific value. Here we part company. Theoretically, you may be correct in claiming that every artifact has potential scientific value. Practically, you are wrong.

I refer to the thousands of pottery vessels and ancient lamps that are essentially duplicates of one another. In one small excavation in Cyprus, archaeologists recently uncovered 2,000 virtually indistinguishable small jugs in a single courtyard, even precious royal seal impressions known as melek handles have been found in abundance — more than 4,000 examples so far.

The basement of museums is simply not large enough to store the artifacts that are likely to be discovered in the future. There is not enough money even to catalogue the finds; as a result, they cannot be found again and become as inaccessible as if they had never been discovered. Indeed, with the help of a computer, sold artifacts could be more accessible than are the pieces stored in bulging museum basements. Prior to sale, each could be photographed and the list of the purchasers could be maintained on the computer. A purchaser could even be required to agree to return the piece if it should become needed for scientific purposes. It would be unrealistic to suggest that illegal digging would stop if artifacts were sold in the open market. But the demand for the clandestine product would be substantially reduced. Who would want an unmarked pot when another was available whose provenance was known, and that was dated stratigraphically by the professional archaeologist who excavated it?

Based on the Passage, answer the following questions:

1. **The primary purpose of the passage is to propose**
- A. an alternative to museum display of artifacts
 - B. a way to curb illegal digging while benefiting the archaeological profession
 - C. a way to distinguish artifacts with scientific value from those that have no such value

- D. the governmental regulation of archaeological sites
- E. a new system for cataloging duplicate artifacts

2. The author implies that all of the following statements about duplicate artifacts are true EXCEPT:

- A. A market for such artifacts already exists.
- B. Such artifacts seldom have scientific value.
- C. There is likely to be a continuing supply of such artifacts.
- D. Museums are well supplied with examples of such artifacts.
- E. Such artifacts frequently exceed in quality in comparison to those already cataloged in museum collections

3. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as a disadvantage of storing artifacts in museum basements?

- A. Museum officials rarely allow scholars access to such artifacts.
- B. Space that could be better used for display is taken up for storage.
- C. Artifacts discovered in one excavation often become separated from each other.
- D. Such artifacts are often damaged by variations in temperature and humidity.
- E. Such artifacts' often remain uncatalogued and thus cannot be located once they are put in storage

4. The author's argument concerning the effect of the official sale of duplicate artifacts on illegal excavation is based on which of the following assumptions?

- A. Prospective purchasers would prefer to buy authenticated artifacts.
- B. The price of illegally excavated artifacts would rise.
- C. Computers could be used to trace sold artifacts.
- D. Illegal excavators would be forced to sell only duplicate artifacts.
- E. Money gained from selling authenticated artifacts could be used to investigate and prosecute illegal excavators

5. The author anticipates which of the following initial objections to the adoption of his proposal?

- A. Museum officials will become unwilling to store artifacts.
- B. An oversupply of salable artifacts will result and the demand for them will fall.
- C. Artifacts that would have been displayed in public places will be sold to private collectors.
- D. Illegal excavators will have an even larger supply of artifacts for resale.
- E. Counterfeiting of artifacts will become more commonplace